

Regular-entry compression pilot 01

Assembly-only pilot comparing the current full regular-entry rendering with shorter book-like variants. Source model entries are unchanged.

Sample

This pilot samples 12 regular entries chosen to cover very simple nouns, ordinary verbs, short note sections, dialect/source notes, and manual comparison cases.

See `regular_compression_pilot_manifest.tsv` for the selected rows and sample reasons.

Variant A: current style baseline

bake — OE *bacan*

Derivation: **bákanq* > *bacan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bákanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	Anglo Frisian Brightening
[no change]	OE A Restoration
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization
	OE Weak Tail Reduction

Outcome: *bacan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel reconstructs the verb as **bakanan* and cites Old English *bacan* beside Old High German *backan*, *bahhan* (Orel 2003). Campbell gives *bacan* as one of the standard examples of Old English A-restoration before a single consonant, and Ringe and Taylor state the same development from **bakan* to Old English *bacan* (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall both record *bacan* as the ordinary Old English verb ‘to bake’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 72; Clark Hall 1960). The target in this entry is therefore the attested infinitive headword itself, not a selected oblique or finite paradigm cell.

Development to Old English From **bákanq*, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **bækanq*. A-restoration then returns the stem vowel to *a* before single *k* plus the back-vocalic infinitive suffix, and later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *bacan* (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The development is therefore straightforward: **bákanq* > *bacan*.

beech — OE *bōc*

Derivation: **bōkō* > *bōc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bōkō*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE High Vowel Apocope
[no change]	
Northwest Germanic	
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	

Outcome: *bōc*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the beech noun as **bōk(j)ō-* and cites Old English *boc*, *bēce* among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). The selected input **bōkō* is the nominative-singular shape of that family, which is the relevant comparison form here.

Old English evidence Kroonen’s Old English evidence already separates the paradigm material: *boc* as the nominative form and *bēce* as an oblique form (Kroonen 2013). The relevant comparator is therefore *bōc*; *bēce* remains related paradigm evidence rather than the form chosen for this comparison.

Development to Old English With nominative input **bōkō*, the development is compact. Northwest Germanic final long *ō* raises to *u*, and later high-vowel apocope leaves *bōc*. The regular comparison is therefore **bōkō > bōc*.

bier — OE *bær*

Derivation: **bérō > bær* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bérō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bær</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*bérū</i>		
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*bæru</i>		

Outcome: *bær*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the noun as **bērō* f. ‘bier’ and cites Old English *bar*, *bær* among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 717). The selected input **bérō* is the same lexeme in the accent notation used here.

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller lemmatize the noun as *bær*, and Kroonen also records *bar* beside it (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717). The target *bær* is therefore a normalized long-vowel spelling of the same noun.

Source note Lexicographic spellings vary between *bær* and *bar*. The normalized target *bær* simply marks the same long vowel explicitly (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717).

Development to Old English From **bérō*, Northwest Germanic final long *ō* raises to *u*, long *ē* lowers to *æ*, and high-vowel apocope yields *bær*. The resulting noun matches the normalized Old English target.

both — OE *bū*

Derivation: **bō > bū* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bō*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	[no change]
[no change]	
Northwest Germanic	
NWGmc Stressed Monosyllable O Raising <i>*bū</i>	

Outcome: *bū*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen treats the Germanic numeral under **ba-* and gives the inherited paradigm **bai*, **bans*, **bōz/*bōns*, **bō*, with Old English *bēgen*, *bā*, and neuter *bū* (Kroonen 2013, 47). For the present entry, the relevant inherited form is the unextended neuter dual **bō*.

The older explanation of *bēgen* derives it from **bō-jen-*, and Orel still gives OE *bezen* (< **bō-jenō*) beside ON *báðir*, OFris *bēthe*, OS *be-thia*, and OHG *bēde*, beide (Orel 2003, 65). Fulk reports that explanation cautiously and notes Seebold's preference for a **bō-p-* analysis instead (Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1). That debate matters for *bēgen* and for the extended forms behind Modern English *both*, German *beide*, and Dutch *beide*; it does not displace the inherited neuter **bō* > *bū* treated here.

Old English evidence The Old English dual paradigm is well established. Brunner gives masculine *bēgen*, feminine *bā*, and neuter *bū* beside *bā*, with compounds such as *bā twā*, *bū tū*, and *bām twām* (Sievers 1965, sect. 324 Anm. 2). Campbell and Fulk present the same basic pattern: masculine *bēgen*, feminine *bā*, neuter *bā*, *bū*, genitive *bēgra*, *bēg(e)a*, and dative *bæm* (Campbell 1959, sect. 683; Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1).

bū is therefore an attested neuter dual form, not a reconstruction. It is the cleanest target for this entry because *bēgen* belongs to the historically more contested **bō-jen-* / analogical zone, while *bā* remains a partner form within the dual paradigm rather than the most straightforward monosyllabic comparison.

Development to Old English **bō* is a stressed monosyllabic form. Campbell cites *cū*, *hū*, *tū*, and *bū* as examples of final accented *ō* > *ū* in the West Germanic stage leading to Old English (Campbell 1959, sect. 122). Brunner states the same development more directly: Auslautendes *ō* erscheint als *û* in *bū* ... *cu* ... *hū*, *tū* (Sievers 1965, sect. 69).

The development is therefore straightforward: **bō* > *bū*.

Form comparison The comparison below is manual. It separates the inherited OE target from the other forms that belong to the same broader lexical history.

Form	Source / stage	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*bō</i> > <i>bū</i>	PGmc neuter dual > OE neuter dual	selected regular comparison	main line of the entry
<i>bēgen</i>	OE masculine dual	attested, but historically contested and at least partly analogical in Kroonen	real OE evidence, not the selected target
<i>bā</i>	OE feminine dual; also neuter variant	attested partner form	part of the OE paradigm, but not the chosen monosyllabic comparator

Form	Source / stage	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>báðir, beide, both</i>	Norse, continental West Germanic, Modern English extended forms	related but different formation	useful background, not the direct continuation of OE <i>bū</i>

bow — OE *bīegan*

Derivation: **bāugijanq* > *bīegan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bāugijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Au Fronting <i>*bāeugijanq</i>
[no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling <i>*bēagijanq</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*bēagijan</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*bēagijān</i>
	Sievers Law Syncope <i>*bēagijān</i>
	OE Velar Palatalization <i>*bēađjān</i>
	OE I Umlaut <i>*bīeđjān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*bīeđjan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy <i>*bīeđzan</i>

Outcome: *bīegan*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs the weak verb as **baugjan* ‘to (make) bend’ and cites Old English *biegan* among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). Ringe and Taylor give the northwest Germanic and West Saxon development more fully as PNWGMce **baugijana* > **bēagjan* > WS OE *biegan* (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The entry therefore concerns the weak causative member of the bend-family, alongside the related strong verb and noun.

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes *biegan*, and Bosworth-Toller records *bigan* with examples such as Ic *bēge mine cneōwa* and Se ord *bīgde upp tō þām hiltum* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 102). The form *bīegan* used here is a normalized spelling of that attested Old English weak verb.

Development to Old English From **bāugijanq*, the stem reaches pre-Old-English **bēagjan*, after which palatalization of **gj* and i-umlaut yield West Saxon *biegan*; Campbell lists *biegan* among the regular *ie* outcomes of **éa* under i-umlaut (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959, 80). The development is therefore straightforward: **bāugijanq* > *bīegan*.

fare — OE *faran*

Derivation: **fāranq* > *faran* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fāranq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	Anglo Frisian Brightening <i>*færanq</i>
[no change]	OE A Restoration <i>*faranq</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*faran</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*farān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*faran</i>

Outcome: *faran*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen gives the inherited strong verb as **faran-*, and Orel gives the same lexeme as **faranan*, both with Old English *faran* among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 132). Campbell also uses *faran* as a standard example of Old English A-restoration (Campbell 1959, 61).

Old English evidence Clark Hall lemmatizes the strong verb as *faran* and separately records weak *færan* ‘to frighten’; *fære*, *færst*, and *færð* belong to present-tense forms of *faran* rather than to the infinitive itself (Clark Hall 1960). Bosworth-Toller preserves the same distinction (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 108). The selected target is therefore the attested citation infinitive *faran*.

Development to Old English From **fáraną*, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **færaną*, but A-restoration before single *r* returns **faraną*; later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *faran* (Campbell 1959, 61). Fulk’s contrast with participial *faren-* < **faræn-* < **faran-* shows why fronting elsewhere in the paradigm does not alter the infinitive headword (Fulk 2018).

guest — OE *ġiest*

Derivation: **gástiz* > *ġiest* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gástiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening	<i>*gæsti</i>
[no change]	Northwest Germanic	OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*ǵæsti</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*ǵesti</i>
PGmc Final Z Deletion		<i>*gásti</i>	OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization
		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*ǵiest</i>

Outcome: *ġiest*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Campbell and Ringe-Taylor treat the noun as an ordinary i-stem whose West Saxon development shows palatal diphthongization, while non-West-Saxon evidence preserves forms of the *gest* type (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Old English evidence Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall record the word under forms such as *gist*, *gest*, *ġiest*, and *gyst* (Bosworth and Toller 1898; Clark Hall 1960). The selected target *ġiest* is the normalized West Saxon form within that attested family.

Development to Old English From **gástiz*, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives a *gæst-* stage, and i-mutation affects the front vowel before the lost high-vocalic ending. In West Saxon the initial palatal environment then produces *ie*, so the regular outcome is *ġiest* (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Dialect note West Saxon *ġiest* is the selected target here. Anglian *gest* and related spellings remain real Old English comparators rather than corrections to that choice (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

learn — OE *liornian*

Derivation: **líznojaną* > *liornian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **líznojaną*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Breaking <i>*líornōjaną</i>
[no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*líornōjan</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*líornōjan</i>
[no change]	OE I Umlaut <i>*líornējan</i>
	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening <i>*líornejan</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*líornejan</i>
	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization <i>*líorneian</i>
	OE Unstressed EI Contraction <i>*líornian</i>

Outcome: *liornian*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Ringe and Taylor place the verb in a class-II weak family of the **lízno-* type (Ringe and Taylor 2014), and Kroonen keeps the same comparative base for the Germanic lexeme (Kroonen 2013). The selected input therefore requires no change of stem class or paradigm cell.

The non-obvious issue is dialectal. Campbell records Northumbrian *liornian* beside *leornian*, and he states that the *eo* of *leornian* is secondary, while Northumbrian preserves forms with *io*, where original *eo* and *io* remain distinct (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

Old English evidence The form modeled here is *liornian*, the Northumbrian member of the Old English family. Dictionary practice more often privileges *leornian* as the ordinary headword (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971), but Campbell's dialect evidence shows that *liornian* is a genuine Old English form (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

This entry therefore remains compact. The point is to state clearly that the selected target belongs to the Northumbrian side of the OE evidence rather than to the leveled *leornian* headword tradition.

Development to Old English From **líznojaną*, the expected Old English developments include rhotacism of *z*, followed by breaking before *r* plus consonant, and the ordinary reduction of the weak verbal ending. The result is *liornian*, preserving the *io* spelling that Campbell associates with Northumbrian where original *eo* and *io* remain distinct (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

Leornian reflects the later *eo* development that Campbell treats as secondary [Campbell (1959), §123 n. 2; §296]. The selected Northumbrian target is therefore the regular comparison form for the *i*-grade member of the family.

Form comparison The comparison below is manual. It distinguishes the regular Northumbrian form modeled here from the better-known West Saxon headword.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*líznojaną</i> → <i>liornian</i>	computed regular output; attested Northumbrian comparison form	selected comparison
<i>leornian</i>	attested later <i>eo</i> form and dictionary headword	useful control, but not the target of this entry

linden — OE lind

Derivation: **lindō* > *lind* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lindō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*lind</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*lindu</i>		

Outcome: *lind*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen cites **lindō-* ‘lime tree’ and gives Old English *lind* as the relevant reflex (Kroonen 2013).

Old English evidence Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both record *lind* as the noun ‘lime-tree, linden’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 630).

Development to Old English From **lindō*, Northwest Germanic final **ō* raising first gives a **lindu* stage, and later high-vowel apocope yields *lind*. The development is therefore straightforward and regular.

Form note The Old English noun represented here is *lind*. Clark Hall also has a separate adjectival *linden* ‘made of linden-wood’, but that is not the noun counterpart for this entry (Clark Hall 1960).

mother — OE *mōder*

Derivation: **mōdēr* > *mōder* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mōdēr*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*mōdær</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*mōder</i>
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*mōdǣr</i>		

Outcome: *mōder*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen and Orel cite the Proto-Germanic r-stem kinship noun as **mōder-* / **mōdēr* (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003).

Old English evidence The transmitted Old English headword tradition is *mōdor* / *modor*, with oblique *mēder* in the paradigm. Clark Hall, Campbell, and Ringe and Taylor all preserve that contrast (Clark Hall 1960; Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Development to Old English From **mōdēr*, the regular suffixal development yields *mōder*. That regular nominative reflex is the form represented here, while the more familiar citation form *mōdor* reflects later levelling within the r-stem paradigm (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Form comparison The note therefore concerns inherited vocalism rather than a different lexeme: *mōder* is the regularized nominative represented here, but dictionaries usually print *mōdor* / *modor*, and the oblique evidence survives in *mēder* (Clark Hall 1960; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

show — OE *scēawian*

Derivation: **skāwōjaną* > *scēawian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skāwōjaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic [no change]	OE Aw Long Diphthong	* <i>skēawōjaną</i>
	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	* <i>skēawōjan</i>
Northwest Germanic [no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization	* <i>skēawōjān</i>
	OE Sk Palatalization	* <i>jēawōjān</i>
	OE I Umlaut	* <i>jēawējān</i>
	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	* <i>jēawējān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	* <i>jēawējan</i>
	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	* <i>jēaweian</i>
	OE Unstressed EI Contraction	* <i>jēawian</i>

Outcome: *scēawian*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Orel and Kroonen cite a Class II verb of the type **skawōjan-*, with OE *scēawian* among the reflexes (Orel 2003; Kroonen 2013, 482). Brunner likewise records the Old English family as *scēawian*, *scāwian*, which places this entry in the ordinary show-verb set rather than in a special finite-cell workaround (Sievers 1965).

Old English evidence Bright lists *scēawian* (W. II.) and also the related form *scēawa* (Bright 1971). The source tradition therefore uses *scēawian*, while the target represented here is the normalized project spelling *scēawian*.

Development to Old English From **skāwōjaną*, Old English *aw* before a following vowel yields *ēaw*, and the Class II suffix keeps **ō* between **w* and **j*. The development therefore runs regularly to *scēawian*, without the direct **aw+j* problem seen in other verb types (Campbell 1959; Orel 2003).

Form note The difference between *scēawian* and *scēawian* is orthographic normalization of initial *sc*, not a difference of lexeme or paradigm cell (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992).

weapon — OE *wāpn*

Derivation: **wēpną* > *wāpn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wēpną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	* <i>wāpn</i>
Northwest Germanic		
NWGmc Long E Lowering	* <i>wāpną</i>	

Outcome: *wāpn*

Reconstruction and comparative evidence Kroonen reconstructs a double-stem noun **wēbna-* ~ **wēpnā-* and cites OE *wāpn* among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 617). The selected input **wēpną* represents the unbroken citation-form noun rather than the later broken simplex.

Old English evidence Campbell's cluster-noun discussion preserves unbroken *wēpn* beside broken *wēpen*-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). Bright contrasts broken nominative *wāpen/wapen* with unbroken oblique *wāpnes*, while Clark Hall lemmatizes the noun under *wapen* and also preserves unbroken forms in compounds and related spellings (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

Development to Old English Northwest Germanic lowering gives *wāpn*, and loss of the final nasal vowel leaves the unbroken cluster word-finally. The selected target is the attested unbroken form *wāpn*.

Form note The ordinary late West Saxon simplex headword is *wāpen*, but Campbell's noun-class discussion also preserves unbroken *wēpn* beside broken *wēpen*-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). *wāpnes* remains the regular unbroken oblique comparator (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

Variant B: compact regular style

These entries keep the heading, derivation line, and boxed trace, but merge the three standard prose sections into one commentary block and retain only shorter note/comparison sections separately.

bake — OE *bacan*

Derivation: **bákanq* > *bacan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bákanq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic [no change]	Anglo Frisian Brightening	<i>*bækanq</i>
	OE A Restoration	<i>*bakanq</i>
Northwest Germanic [no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*bakan</i>
	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*bakʌn</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*bakan</i>

Commentary Orel reconstructs the verb as **bakanan* and cites Old English *bacan* beside Old High German *backan*, *bahhan* (Orel 2003). Campbell gives *bacan* as one of the standard examples of Old English A-restoration before a single consonant, and Ringe and Taylor state the same development from **bakan* to Old English *bacan* (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall both record *bacan* as the ordinary Old English verb ‘to bake’ (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 72; Clark Hall 1960). The target in this entry is therefore the attested infinitive headword itself, not a selected oblique or finite paradigm cell.

From **bákanq*, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **bækanq*. A-restoration then returns the stem vowel to *a* before single *k* plus the back-vocalic infinitive suffix, and later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *bacan* (Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014). The development is therefore straightforward: **bákanq* > *bacan*.

beech — OE *bōc*

Derivation: **bōkō* > *bōc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bōkō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic [no change]	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bōk</i>
Northwest Germanic		
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*bōku</i>	

Commentary Kroonen gives the beech noun as **bōk(j)ō-* and cites Old English *boc*, *bēce* among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). The selected input **bōkō* is the nominative-singular shape of that family, which is the relevant comparison form here.

Kroonen’s Old English evidence already separates the paradigm material: *boc* as the nominative form and *bēce* as an oblique form (Kroonen 2013). The relevant comparator is therefore *bōc*; *bēce* remains related paradigm evidence rather than the form chosen for this comparison.

With nominative input **bōkō*, the development is compact. Northwest Germanic final long *ō* raises to *u*, and later high-vowel apocope leaves *bōc*. The regular comparison is therefore **bōkō* > *bōc*.

bier — OE *bǣr*

Derivation: **bérō* > *bǣr* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bérō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bǣr</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*béru</i>		
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*bǣru</i>		

Commentary Kroonen reconstructs the noun as **bērō*- f. ‘bier’ and cites Old English *bar*, *bær* among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 717). The selected input **bérō* is the same lexeme in the accent notation used here.

Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller lemmatize the noun as *bær*, and Kroonen also records *bar* beside it (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717). The target *bǣr* is therefore a normalized long-vowel spelling of the same noun.

From **bérō*, Northwest Germanic final long *ō* raises to *u*, long *ē* lowers to *ǣ*, and high-vowel apocope yields *bǣr*. The resulting noun matches the normalized Old English target.

Source note Lexicographic spellings vary between *bær* and *bar*. The normalized target *bǣr* simply marks the same long vowel explicitly (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717).

both — OE *bū*

Derivation: **bō* > *bū* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		[no change]	
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Stressed Monosyllable O Raising <i>*bū</i>			

Commentary Kroonen treats the Germanic numeral under **ba-* and gives the inherited paradigm **bai*, **bans*, **bōz*/**bōns*, **bō*, with Old English *bēgen*, *bā*, and neuter *bū* (Kroonen 2013, 47). For the present entry, the relevant inherited form is the unextended neuter dual **bō*.

The older explanation of *bēgen* derives it from **bō-jen-*, and Orel still gives OE *bezen* (< **bō-jenō*) beside ON *báðir*, OFris *bēthe*, OS *be-thia*, and OHG *bēde*, *beide* (Orel 2003, 65). Fulk reports that explanation cautiously and notes Seebold’s preference for a **bō-p-* analysis instead (Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1). That debate matters for *bēgen* and for the extended forms behind Modern English *both*, German *beide*, and Dutch *beide*; it does not displace the inherited neuter **bō* > *bū* treated here.

The Old English dual paradigm is well established. Brunner gives masculine *bēgen*, feminine *bā*, and neuter *bū* beside *bā*, with compounds such as *bā twā*, *bū tū*, and *bām twām* (Sievers 1965, sect. 324 Anm. 2). Campbell and Fulk present the same basic pattern: masculine *bēgen*, feminine *bā*, neuter *bā*, *bū*, genitive *bēgra*, *bēg(e)a*, and dative *bām* (Campbell 1959, sect. 683; Fulk 2018, sect. 10.1).

bū is therefore an attested neuter dual form, not a reconstruction. It is the cleanest target for this entry because *bēgen* belongs to the historically more contested **bō-jen-* / analogical zone, while *bā* remains a partner form within the dual paradigm rather than the most straightforward monosyllabic comparison.

**bō* is a stressed monosyllabic form. Campbell cites *cū*, *hū*, *tū*, and *bū* as examples of final accented *ō > ū* in the West Germanic stage leading to Old English (Campbell 1959, sect. 122). Brunner states the same development more directly: Auslautendes *ō* erscheint als *û* in *bū ... cū ... hū, tū* (Sievers 1965, sect. 69).

The development is therefore straightforward: **bō > bū*.

Comparison The comparison below is manual. It separates the inherited OE target from the other forms that belong to the same broader lexical history.

Form	Source / stage	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*bō > bū</i>	PGmc neuter dual > OE neuter dual	selected regular comparison	main line of the entry
<i>bēgen</i>	OE masculine dual	attested, but historically contested and at least partly analogical in Kroonen	real OE evidence, not the selected target
<i>bā</i>	OE feminine dual; also neuter variant	attested partner form	part of the OE paradigm, but not the chosen monosyllabic comparator
<i>báðir, beide, both</i>	Norse, continental West Germanic, Modern English extended forms	related but different formation	useful background, not the direct continuation of OE <i>bū</i>

bow — OE *bīegan*

Derivation: **bāugijanq > bīegan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bāugijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Au Fronting
[no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization
	Sievers Law Syncope
	OE Velar Palatalization
	OE I Umlaut
	OE Weak Tail Reduction
	OE J Loss After Heavy

Commentary Kroonen reconstructs the weak verb as **baugjan-* ‘to (make) bend’ and cites Old English *biegan* among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013). Ringe and Taylor give the northwest Germanic and West Saxon development more fully as PNWGMce **baugijana > *béagjan > WS OE biegan* (Ringe and Taylor 2014). The entry therefore concerns the weak causative member of the bend-family, alongside the related strong verb and noun.

Clark Hall lemmatizes *biegan*, and Bosworth-Toller records *bigan* with examples such as Ic *bēge mīne cneowa* and Se ord *bīgde upp tō pām hiltum* (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 102). The form *bīegan* used here is a normalized spelling of that attested Old English weak verb.

From **báugijanq*, the stem reaches pre-Old-English **bēagjan*, after which palatalization of **gj* and i-umlaut yield West Saxon *biegan*; Campbell lists *biegan* among the regular *ie* outcomes of **éa* under i-umlaut (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Campbell 1959, 80). The development is therefore straightforward: **báugijanq* > *bīegan*.

fare — OE faran

Derivation: **fáranq* > *faran* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fáranq*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening	<i>*færaną</i>
[no change]		OE A Restoration	<i>*faraną</i>
Northwest Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*faran</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*farən</i>
[no change]		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*faran</i>

Commentary Kroonen gives the inherited strong verb as **faran-*, and Orel gives the same lexeme as **faranan*, both with Old English *faran* among the reflexes (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003, 132). Campbell also uses *faran* as a standard example of Old English A-restoration (Campbell 1959, 61).

Clark Hall lemmatizes the strong verb as *faran* and separately records weak *færan* ‘to frighten’; *fære*, *færst*, and *færð* belong to present-tense forms of *faran* rather than to the infinitive itself (Clark Hall 1960). Bosworth-Toller preserves the same distinction (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 108). The selected target is therefore the attested citation infinitive *faran*.

From **fáranq*, Anglo-Frisian brightening first gives **færanq*, but A-restoration before single *r* returns **faranq*; later apocope and weak-tail reduction yield *faran* (Campbell 1959, 61). Fulk’s contrast with participial *faren-* < **faræn-* < **faran-* shows why fronting elsewhere in the paradigm does not alter the infinitive headword (Fulk 2018).

guest — OE ġiest

Derivation: **gástiz* > *ġiest* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gástiz*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening	<i>*gæsti</i>
[no change]		OE Velar Palatalization	<i>*ǵæsti</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*ǵesti</i>
Northwest Germanic		OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization	<i>*ǵiesti</i>
PGmc Final Z Deletion	<i>*gásti</i>	OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*ǵiest</i>

Commentary Campbell and Ringe-Taylor treat the noun as an ordinary i-stem whose West Saxon development shows palatal diphthongization, while non-West-Saxon evidence preserves forms of the *gest* type (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall record the word under forms such as *gist*, *gest*, *giest*, and *gyst* (Bosworth and Toller 1898; Clark Hall 1960). The selected target *ġiest* is the normalized West Saxon form within that attested family.

From **gástiz*, Anglo-Frisian brightening gives a *gæst-* stage, and i-mutation affects the front vowel before the lost high-vocalic ending. In West Saxon the initial palatal environment then produces *ie*, so the regular outcome is *ġiest* (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Dialect note West Saxon *ġiest* is the selected target here. Anglian *gest* and related spellings remain real Old English comparators rather than corrections to that choice (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

learn — OE liornian

Derivation: **līznōjanq* > *liornian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **līznōjanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Breaking <i>*līornōjanq</i>
[no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*līornōjan</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*līornōjān</i>
[no change]	OE I Umlaut <i>*līornejān</i>
	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening <i>*līornejān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*līornejan</i>
	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization <i>*līorneian</i>
	OE Unstressed EI Contraction <i>*līornian</i>

Commentary Ringe and Taylor place the verb in a class-II weak family of the **līznō-* type (Ringe and Taylor 2014), and Kroonen keeps the same comparative base for the Germanic lexeme (Kroonen 2013). The selected input therefore requires no change of stem class or paradigm cell.

The non-obvious issue is dialectal. Campbell records Northumbrian *liornian* beside *leornian*, and he states that the *eo* of *leornian* is secondary, while Northumbrian preserves forms with *io*, where original *eo* and *io* remain distinct (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

The form modeled here is *liornian*, the Northumbrian member of the Old English family. Dictionary practice more often privileges *leornian* as the ordinary headword (Clark Hall 1960; Bright 1971), but Campbell's dialect evidence shows that *liornian* is a genuine Old English form (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

This entry therefore remains compact. The point is to state clearly that the selected target belongs to the Northumbrian side of the OE evidence rather than to the leveled *leornian* headword tradition.

From **līznōjanq*, the expected Old English developments include rhotacism of *z*, followed by breaking before *r* plus consonant, and the ordinary reduction of the weak verbal ending. The result is *liornian*, preserving the *io* spelling that Campbell associates with Northumbrian where original *eo* and *io* remain distinct (Campbell 1959, sect. 123 n. 2).

Leornian reflects the later *eo* development that Campbell treats as secondary [Campbell (1959), §123 n. 2; §296]. The selected Northumbrian target is therefore the regular comparison form for the *i*-grade member of the family.

Comparison The comparison below is manual. It distinguishes the regular Northumbrian form modeled here from the better-known West Saxon headword.

Form	Status	Relevance to this entry
<i>*līznōjanq</i> -> <i>liornian</i>	computed regular output; attested Northumbrian comparison form	selected comparison
<i>leornian</i>	attested later <i>eo</i> form and dictionary headword	useful control, but not the target of this entry

linden — OE lind

Derivation: **līndō* > *lind* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lindō*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE High Vowel Apocope
[no change]	<i>*lind</i>
Northwest Germanic	
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*lindu</i>

Commentary Kroonen cites **lindō*- ‘lime tree’ and gives Old English *lind* as the relevant reflex (Kroonen 2013).

Clark Hall and Bosworth-Toller both record *lind* as the noun ‘lime-tree, linden’ (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 630).

From **lindō*, Northwest Germanic final **ō* raising first gives a **lindu* stage, and later high-vowel apocope yields *lind*. The development is therefore straightforward and regular.

Form note The Old English noun represented here is *lind*. Clark Hall also has a separate adjectival *linden* ‘made of linden-wood’, but that is not the noun counterpart for this entry (Clark Hall 1960).

mother — OE *mōder*

Derivation: **mōdēr* > *mōder* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mōdēr*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening
[no change]	OE Unstressed AE Merger
Northwest Germanic	
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*mōdær</i>
	<i>*mōder</i>

Commentary Kroonen and Orel cite the Proto-Germanic r-stem kinship noun as **mōder-* / **mōdēr* (Kroonen 2013; Orel 2003).

The transmitted Old English headword tradition is *mōdor* / *modor*, with oblique *mēder* in the paradigm. Clark Hall, Campbell, and Ringe and Taylor all preserve that contrast (Clark Hall 1960; Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

From **mōdēr*, the regular suffixal development yields *mōder*. That regular nominative reflex is the form represented here, while the more familiar citation form *mōdor* reflects later levelling within the r-stem paradigm (Campbell 1959; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

Comparison The note therefore concerns inherited vocalism rather than a different lexeme: *mōder* is the regularized nominative represented here, but dictionaries usually print *mōdor* / *modor*, and the oblique evidence survives in *mēder* (Clark Hall 1960; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

show — OE *sċēawian*

Derivation: **skāwōjaną* > *sċēawian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skáwōjaną*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
West Germanic	OE Aw Long Diphthong	<i>*skéawōjaną</i>
[no change]	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*skéawōjan</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*skéawōjan</i>
[no change]	OE Sk Palatalization	<i>*jéawōjan</i>
	OE I Umlaut	<i>*jéawējan</i>
	OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*jéawējan</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*jéawējan</i>
	OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	<i>*jéaweian</i>
	OE Unstressed EI Contraction	<i>*jéawian</i>

Commentary Orel and Kroonen cite a Class II verb of the type **skawōjan-*, with OE *scēawian* among the reflexes (Orel 2003; Kroonen 2013, 482). Brunner likewise records the Old English family as *scēawian*, *scāwian*, which places this entry in the ordinary show-verb set rather than in a special finite-cell workaround (Sievers 1965).

Bright lists *scēawian* (W. II.) and also the related form *scēawa* (Bright 1971). The source tradition therefore uses *scēawian*, while the target represented here is the normalized project spelling *scēawian*.

From **skáwōjaną*, Old English *aw* before a following vowel yields *ēaw*, and the Class II suffix keeps **ō* between **w* and **j*. The development therefore runs regularly to *scēawian*, without the direct **aw+j* problem seen in other verb types (Campbell 1959; Orel 2003).

Form note The difference between *scēawian* and *scēawian* is orthographic normalization of initial , not a difference of lexeme or paradigm cell (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992).

weapon — OE wāpn

Derivation: **wēpną* > *wāpn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wēpną*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes	
West Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*wāpn</i>
[no change]		
Northwest Germanic		
NWGmc Long E Lowering		<i>*wāpną</i>

Commentary Kroonen reconstructs a double-stem noun **wēbna-* ~ **wēpna-* and cites OE *wāpn* among its reflexes (Kroonen 2013, 617). The selected input **wēpną* represents the unbroken citation-form noun rather than the later broken simplex.

Campbell's cluster-noun discussion preserves unbroken *wēpn* beside broken *wēpen*-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). Bright contrasts broken nominative *wāpen*/*wapen* with unbroken oblique *wāpnes*, while Clark Hall lemmatizes the noun under *wapen* and also preserves unbroken forms in compounds and related spellings (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

Northwest Germanic lowering gives *wāpn*, and loss of the final nasal vowel leaves the unbroken cluster word-finally. The selected target is the attested unbroken form *wāpn*.

Form note The ordinary late West Saxon simplex headword is *wāpen*, but Campbell's noun-class discussion also preserves unbroken *wēpn* beside broken *wēpen*-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). *wāpnes* remains the regular unbroken oblique comparator (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

Variant C: minimal regular style (experimental)

These entries keep the heading, derivation line, and boxed trace, then retain only explicit short note sections. Manual comparison tables are replaced by a mechanical editorial placeholder.

bake — OE *bacan*

Derivation: **bákaną* > *bacan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bákaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening	<i>*bækaną</i>
[no change]		OE A Restoration	<i>*bakaną</i>
Northwest Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*bakan</i>
[no change]		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*bakąn</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*bakan</i>

beech — OE *bōc*

Derivation: **bōkō* > *bōc* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bōkō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bōk</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*bōku</i>		

bier — OE *bæ̆r*

Derivation: **bé̆rō* > *bæ̆r* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bé̆rō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bæ̆r</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*bé̆ru</i>		
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*bæ̆ru</i>		

Source note Lexicographic spellings vary between *bæ̆r* and *bar*. The normalized target *bæ̆r* simply marks the same long vowel explicitly (Clark Hall 1960; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73; Kroonen 2013, 717).

both — OE *bū*

Derivation: **bō* > *bū* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bō*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	[no change]
[no change]	
Northwest Germanic	
NWGmc Stressed Monosyllable O Raising <i>*bū</i>	

Comparison *Manual comparison retained only in fuller variants.*

bow — OE *bīegan*

Derivation: **bāugijanq* > *bīegan* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **bāugijanq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Au Fronting <i>*bāeugijanq</i>
[no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling <i>*bēagijanq</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*bēagijan</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*bēagijān</i>
	Sievers Law Syncope <i>*bēagjān</i>
	OE Velar Palatalization <i>*bēadȝjān</i>
	OE I Umlaut <i>*bīedȝjān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*bīedȝjan</i>
	OE J Loss After Heavy <i>*bīedȝan</i>

fare — OE *faran*

Derivation: **fāranq* > *faran* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **fāranq*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	Anglo Frisian Brightening <i>*færanq</i>
[no change]	OE A Restoration <i>*faranq</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*faran</i>
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*farān</i>
	OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*faran</i>

guest — OE *ġiest*

Derivation: **gástiz* > *ġiest* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **gástiz*

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	Anglo Frisian Brightening <i>*gæsti</i>
[no change]	OE Velar Palatalization <i>*ȝæsti</i>
Northwest Germanic	OE I Umlaut <i>*ġæsti</i>
PGmc Final Z Deletion <i>*gásti</i>	OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization <i>*ȝiæsti</i>
	OE High Vowel Apocope <i>*ȝiest</i>

Dialect note West Saxon *ġiest* is the selected target here. Anglian *gest* and related spellings remain real Old English comparators rather than corrections to that choice (Ringe and Taylor 2014; Bosworth and Toller 1898).

learn — OE *liornian*

Derivation: **líznojaną* > *liornian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **líznojaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE Breaking	<i>*líornōjaną</i>
[no change]	Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*líornōjan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*líornōjan</i>
		OE I Umlaut	<i>*líornejan</i>
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*líornejan</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*líornejan</i>
OE Intervocalic J Vocalization		<i>*líorneian</i>	
OE Unstressed EI Contraction		<i>*líornian</i>	

Comparison *Manual comparison retained only in fuller variants.*

linden — OE *lind*

Derivation: **lindō* > *lind* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **lindō*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*lind</i>
[no change]	Northwest Germanic		
		NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*lindu</i>

Form note The Old English noun represented here is *lind*. Clark Hall also has a separate adjectival *linden* ‘made of linden-wood’, but that is not the noun counterpart for this entry (Clark Hall 1960).

mother — OE *mōder*

Derivation: **mōdēr* > *mōder* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **mōdēr*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*mōdær</i>
[no change]	Northwest Germanic	OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*mōder</i>
		NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*mōdær</i>

Comparison The note therefore concerns inherited vocalism rather than a different lexeme: *mōder* is the regularized nominative represented here, but dictionaries usually print *mōdor* / *modor*, and the oblique evidence survives in *mēder* (Clark Hall 1960; Ringe and Taylor 2014).

show — OE *scēawian*

Derivation: **skáwōjaną* > *scēawian* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **skáwōjaną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic		
[no change]		OE Aw Long Diphthong <i>*skéawōjaną</i>
		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*skéawōjan</i>
		OE Secondary Nasalization <i>*skéawōjən</i>
Northwest Germanic		OE Sk Palatalization <i>*jéawōjən</i>
[no change]		OE I Umlaut <i>*jéawējən</i>
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening <i>*jéawejən</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction <i>*jéawejan</i>
		OE Intervocalic J Vocalization <i>*jéaweian</i>
		OE Unstressed EI Contraction <i>*jéawian</i>

Form note The difference between *scēawian* and *scēawian* is orthographic normalization of initial , not a difference of lexeme or paradigm cell (Campbell 1959; Hogg 1992).

weapon — OE *wæpn*

Derivation: **wépną* > *wæpn* (regular).

Derivation trace Proto input: **wépną*

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope <i>*wæpn</i>
[no change]		
Northwest Germanic		
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*wæpną</i>	

Form note The ordinary late West Saxon simplex headword is *wæpen*, but Campbell's noun-class discussion also preserves unbroken *wépn* beside broken *wépen*-type forms (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226–27). *wæpnes* remains the regular unbroken oblique comparator (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

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